

Company User Guide

Everything your team needs to run a Request for Quotation, end to end

Welcome to RFQ Hub. This guide walks you through setting up your company account, publishing your first Request for Quotation (RFQ), and managing responses from suppliers through to a decision.

RFQ Hub gives your company its own branded space to create RFQs, invite contractors, answer their questions, and review what comes back — all in one place, independent of any other company on the platform.

New in this edition RFQs are now saved as drafts and published as a separate step, can cover more than one province, and stay visible for three days after closing so suppliers can still ask questions. There is also a public questions and answers thread on every RFQ, an Expand Supplier Search tool, and per-stage permissions for your team.

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STEP 1 Activate Your Account

You'll receive an email invitation to join RFQ Hub. Click the link in that email — it opens RFQ Hub with your account already recognised and prompts you to choose a password.

- Enter a password (at least 6 characters) and confirm it.
- Click **Set Password & Continue**.
- You'll be taken straight into your company dashboard — there is no separate sign-up step.

SCREENSHOT — The "Choose a Password" screen you land on after clicking the invite link.

The password screen you see after clicking your invite link

STEP 2 Log In

Once your password is set, return to RFQ Hub at any time by clicking **Sign In** in the top-right corner and entering your email and password.

SCREENSHOT — The Staff Login screen, showing the email and password fields and the "Forgot password?" link.

The staff login screen

If you forget your password

Click **Forgot Password** on the login screen and enter your email. We send you a six-digit code rather than a link, because email security scanners at some companies open links automatically and use them up before you get there. Enter that code along with your new password to get straight back in.

Account lockout After **five failed login attempts**, an account is locked for **one hour**. This protects against someone guessing passwords. If a colleague reports being locked out, the lock clears by itself after the hour — there is nothing to reset on your side.

STEP 3 Set Up Your Company Profile

Your dashboard is organised into tabs across the top: Create RFQ, RFQ Console, Review Submissions, Team, and Settings. Before creating your first RFQ, open **Settings** and add your company details. This information appears on every RFQ page suppliers see, so it is worth getting right from the start.

- Upload your company logo (PNG, JPG, SVG or WebP — it uploads immediately). It appears in your dashboard header and on your public RFQ listings.
- Use the **Logo Size** slider if your logo sits too large or too small against the header.
- Confirm your company name.
- Add a contact email, phone number and address so suppliers know how to reach you.

SCREENSHOT — The Settings tab showing Logo, Logo Size slider, Company Name, Contact Email, Contact Phone and Address.

Company Settings — logo, name and contact details

STEP 4 Build an RFQ

Open the **Create RFQ** tab and fill in the form. Nothing goes live at this stage — you can save your work and come back to it. Publishing is a separate, deliberate step covered in Step 5.

SCREENSHOT — The full Create New RFQ form, from RFQ Name/Title down to the Save Draft and Publish buttons.

The Create RFQ form

Field guide

Field	Required?	What it's for
RFQ Name/Title	Required	A short, clear title, e.g. "Safety Equipment Quotes".
Project Name	Required	The project this RFQ relates to.
Description	Required	Details of what you're looking for.
Province(s)	Required	Tick every province the work or supply covers — you are no longer limited to one. Suppliers filter the public portal by province, and registered suppliers are alerted based on the provinces they chose, so this directly controls who finds and hears about your RFQ. There is a Select All toggle.
Town / Area	Optional	A more specific location within the province.
Submission Deadline	Required	The date and time suppliers must submit by.
Budget	Optional	An indicative budget. If provided, it's shown to suppliers on the RFQ page.
Visibility	Required	Open (listed on the public portal) or Closed (invite-only) — see the section on this below.
Required Documents	Required	The documents suppliers must submit. See below for standard vs custom.
Attach RFQ Document(s)	Optional	Upload specs, drawings or other files for suppliers to download before applying.
Contractor Email Addresses	Required for Closed RFQs	One email per line. Each contractor gets a personal invite link, emailed automatically on publish. Optional for Open RFQs, where you can still invite specific people in addition to the public listing.

Required documents: standard vs custom

There are two buttons under Required Documents, and the difference matters.

- **+ Add Standard Document** picks from the seven document types every supplier already holds in the Supplier Database: CIPC Registration / ID, Proof of Address, SARS Information, Proof of Banking, B-BBEE Affidavit/Certificate, Health & Safety Certificate, and Special Permits/Registrations. Because the system recognises these, a supplier who already has one on file is offered the chance to reuse it rather than hunting for the file again — which noticeably improves how many people finish an application.
- **+ Add Custom Document Type** is for anything specific to this RFQ, such as a method statement or a priced bill of quantities. You can optionally link a custom row to one of the seven standard types if it is really the same document under a different name.

Each document row can be marked mandatory or optional, and can require an expiry date. If you tick **Requires Expiry Date**, the supplier must enter when that document expires, and you will see a clear red flag on their submission if it had already expired when they applied.

A note on reuse A document set to require an expiry date cannot be reused from a supplier's file, because a stored document does not carry a per-RFQ expiry. Use expiry dates where currency

genuinely matters, such as tax clearance, and leave it off elsewhere so suppliers get the benefit of reuse.

Preview and save

-  **Preview** shows you the RFQ exactly as a supplier will see it. Worth a look before publishing.
-  **Save Draft** stores your work without making anything visible. Drafts appear in the RFQ Console with a Continue Editing button, and no emails are sent.
-  **Publish RFQ** takes it live. This is covered next.

STEP 5 Publish It

Publishing is deliberately separate from creating, because it is the moment your RFQ reaches the outside world and it cannot be undone by editing alone.

When you click  **Publish RFQ**, one of two things happens depending on visibility:

- An **Open** RFQ becomes publicly listed, and registered suppliers whose chosen provinces match yours are notified by email and SMS.
- A **Closed** RFQ activates its invite links, and the contractors you listed are emailed theirs.

Check before you publish Because publishing notifies suppliers immediately, read the RFQ through once via **Preview** first — especially the deadline, the provinces and the required documents. You can still edit afterwards, but anyone already notified will have seen the original.

Open vs Closed RFQs

When you create an RFQ you choose whether it is Open or Closed. This controls who can see and apply to it.

Visibility	What happens
Closed — Invite Only	Only reachable via the invite links you send. Not listed anywhere public. Contractor email addresses are required.
Open — Public Portal	Listed on the public Open Opportunities portal for anyone to find and apply to, with your company logo and name shown. Contractor email addresses are optional — you can still invite specific people in addition to the public listing.

The public portal lets suppliers filter by province, so accurate location details help the right suppliers find your listing.

SCREENSHOT — An Open RFQ as it appears on the public portal, showing the OPEN badge, closing date, location and countdown.

How an Open RFQ appears on the public portal

What happens after an RFQ closes

An RFQ does not disappear the moment its deadline passes. For **three days** afterwards it stays visible on the public portal marked  **Closed — Questions Only**.

- No new applications can be submitted. The View Opportunity button is replaced with Ask a Question.

- Suppliers can still contact you about the RFQ — most often because they realised they left a document out, or want to check something about what they sent.
- After three days the listing drops off the public portal entirely.

This window exists because suppliers frequently notice a problem with their own submission just after the deadline, and previously had no way to reach you.

STEP 6 Track Your RFQs

The **RFQ Console** tab lists every RFQ you have created — drafts included — with a live response rate showing how many invited or interested suppliers have submitted, and how many days remain before the deadline.

SCREENSHOT — The RFQ Console showing an RFQ card with response rate, description, budget, required documents and contractor links.

RFQ Console — track responses and deadlines at a glance

What you can do from the console

Action	When you would use it
 Continue Editing	Pick up a draft where you left off.
 Delete Draft	Discard a draft you no longer want. Only available before publishing.
 Edit RFQ	Change a published RFQ. Suppliers already notified saw the original, so tell them if something material changed.
Unpublish	Pull a live RFQ off the public portal — it becomes unreachable even by direct link. Submissions already received are kept.
Republish	Put an unpublished RFQ back on the portal.
+ Add Contractor	Generate an extra invite link for a Closed RFQ after it has gone out.
Copy All Links	Copy every contractor invite link at once, for pasting into your own email.

STEP 7 Answer Supplier Questions

Every RFQ carries a public **Questions & Answers** thread. Suppliers can ask a question without logging in, and you are emailed when one arrives. Questions appear in the RFQ Console with a **Reply** button.

When you answer, you choose the visibility:

- **Public** publishes the question and your answer on the RFQ page, where every current and future supplier can see it. Use this whenever the answer affects how anyone would price or prepare their bid.
- **Private** sends the answer only to the person who asked.

Fairness If one supplier asks something that changes the requirement — a clarified specification, a corrected quantity — answering publicly keeps every bidder on the same footing and protects you if the award is ever questioned.

SCREENSHOT — The Reply to Question modal, showing the question, the answer box and the Public/Private visibility choice.

Answering a supplier question

STEP 8 Expand Your Supplier Search

If an RFQ is not attracting enough responses, open it in the RFQ Console and use **Expand Supplier Search**. Pick additional provinces and the system emails registered suppliers in those provinces about your RFQ.

This is useful when a deadline is approaching and you have too few bids, or when the work could reasonably be done by a supplier based further afield. It only contacts suppliers who were not already notified.

STEP 9 Review Submissions

As suppliers apply, they appear in the **Review Submissions** tab. Filter by RFQ or by status, then open a submission to see the supplier's details and documents.

SCREENSHOT — The Review Submissions list with the RFQ and Status filter dropdowns and several submission cards.

Review Submissions — filter and manage supplier responses

The six statuses

Each submission moves through a status you control from the dropdown in the submission window:

Status	Meaning
Submitted	Newly arrived, not yet looked at.
Under Review	You are assessing it.
Request More Information	You have asked the supplier for something further — see below.
Response Received	Set automatically when the supplier replies to that request.
Approved	Successful.
Rejected	Unsuccessful.

What you see in a submission

- Company name, email, phone and company registration number.
- Which RFQ it relates to, and when it was submitted.
- Every document, with a Download button.
- A  **Reused from Supplier Database** note on any document the supplier reused rather than uploading fresh — it is the same file they registered with.
- The expiry date where one was required, and a  **Already expired at time of submission** flag in red if the document was out of date when they applied.
- Any supplementary documents they chose to attach beyond what you asked for.

Please note Suppliers are asked for a **Price Estimate** when they apply, and it is stored against their submission. It is **not yet displayed** in this window — ask iHubSA to surface it if you need to compare prices side by side.

Asking a supplier for more information

If a submission is missing something — a certificate, a clearer figure, an extra document — open it and choose **Request More Information** from the status dropdown instead of Approved or Rejected. Describe what you need, then click **Send Request**.

- The supplier receives an email with your message and a link. No login is required on their side.
- They reply with a message and can upload documents directly onto their existing submission.
- The status updates itself to Response Received, so you can see at a glance who you are still waiting on.

SCREENSHOT — A submission open in the detail window, with the message box and the Request More Information dropdown.

Requesting more information from a submission

STEP 10 Invite Your Team and Set Permissions

Click **Team** to see everyone with access and invite colleagues by email. Each person you invite gets their own login and goes through the same activation step you did in Step 1.

SCREENSHOT — The Team tab showing current members, pending invites and the Invite a Teammate box.

Team — see current members and invite new teammates

Controlling what each person can do

The account that set the company up is the **Owner** and always has full access. Everyone else is **Staff**, and by default also has full access — but you can restrict them.

Click the permissions button beside a team member to open a grid of the six submission stages: Submitted, Under Review, Request More Information, Response Received, Approved and Rejected. For each stage you grant **View**, **Edit**, or neither.

- Ticking Edit automatically ticks View — you cannot edit a stage you cannot see.
- A common arrangement is to let junior staff view and progress submissions up to Under Review, while reserving Approved and Rejected for whoever signs off.

Owner access The Owner cannot be restricted, and permissions never apply to them. If you need someone limited, invite them as Staff rather than handing over the Owner account.

Where Suppliers Come From

Suppliers register once on the public portal rather than per RFQ, forming a shared Supplier Database across the platform.

- A supplier provides company details, contact details, the services they offer, the areas they can service, and their supporting documents.
- Each one is issued a **supplier number** (for example SUP00042) and receives a confirmation email listing that number and the documents received.
- They choose which provinces they want to hear about, and are emailed and texted when a matching Open RFQ is published.
- They can update their own details and replace expiring documents at any time through a private link in their emails, without contacting you.

This is why linking your required documents to the standard types matters: the more of your requirements a supplier already holds on file, the more likely they are to finish the application rather than abandon it.

Need Help?

If you run into any issues, or anything in this guide doesn't match what you're seeing on screen, reach out and we'll help you sort it out.

- Email: ihubsa@gmail.com
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